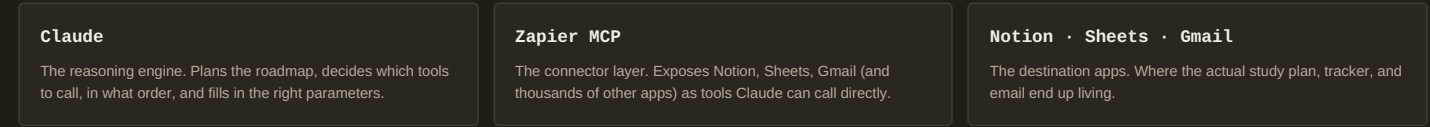


From One Prompt to an Automated Study System

How I used Claude + Zapier MCP to turn a single plain-English request into a 30-day DSA interview-prep roadmap, a live Notion page, a self-filled Google Sheets tracker, and an email — in under 5 minutes, with no manual copy-pasting between apps.



GOAL	TOOL CALLS MADE	TIME TAKEN	PLAN
30-Day DSA Roadmap	~15 MCP calls	< 5 minutes	Zapier Free Tier

00 — OVERVIEW

What I built today

I asked Claude, in one message, to connect to Zapier, draft a 30-day Data Structures & Algorithms study plan for coding interviews, and then push that plan out into three different tools — without me touching Notion, Sheets, or Gmail myself. Claude handled the connection, the planning, and every individual app action end-to-end.

THE FOUR DELIVERABLES, FROM ONE PROMPT

- **A 30-day study roadmap** covering arrays, strings, linked lists, stacks, queues, trees, graphs, dynamic programming, greedy algorithms, and four dedicated revision days.
- **A Notion page** titled "30-Day DSA Study Plan" with the full day-by-day breakdown, written and formatted automatically.
- **A Google Sheets progress tracker** with Day / Topic / Status / Problems Solved / Notes columns, pre-filled for all 30 days.
- **An email** delivering the entire plan plus links to the Notion page and the tracker, straight to my inbox.

3 APPS AUTOMATED	30 DAYS PLANNED & TRACKED	~15 TOOL CALLS, FULLY LOGGED	0 MANUAL COPY-PASTES
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01 — UNDER THE HOOD

What is Zapier MCP, really?

MCP stands for **Model Context Protocol** — an open standard that lets an AI assistant call external tools directly inside a conversation, instead of just describing what you should go click yourself. Zapier MCP is Zapier's implementation of that standard: a single connector that, once linked to Claude, exposes a huge catalogue of app integrations as callable "tools."

ONE CONNECTOR, THOUSANDS OF APPS

Instead of building a separate integration for Notion, another for Gmail, another for Sheets, Zapier MCP sits in front of Zapier's entire app catalogue. Connect it once, and Claude can reach Notion, Gmail, Sheets, Slack, HubSpot, Trello, and thousands more — all through the same authenticated session.

READ ACTIONS VS. WRITE ACTIONS

Every app exposes two flavors of tool: read actions that fetch existing data (find a page, list rows, check inbox), and write actions that create or change something (create a page, add a row, send an email). Claude picks the right one automatically based on what the task needs.

DYNAMIC PARAMETER DISCOVERY

Before filling in a field like "which Notion page" or "which spreadsheet," Claude can ask Zapier MCP what the valid options actually are, and choose from real, live data — instead of guessing or hard-coding an ID.

SKILLS — SAVED, REUSABLE WORKFLOWS

Zapier MCP also supports "Skills": named, multi-step workflows that can be listed, fetched, and run on demand. Today's setup used the built-in *onboarding* skill to confirm which apps were already connected before doing any real work.

RAW API ACCESS FOR EDGE CASES

For the handful of moments a pre-built action doesn't cover exactly what's needed, Zapier MCP also exposes raw "API Request" actions, so Claude can call the underlying app API directly and verify the result — which is exactly how today's spreadsheet data was double-checked and corrected mid-task.

Connecting Zapier MCP to Claude

This is the entire one-time setup. No API keys, no code, no separate dashboard hopping.

- 1

Ask Claude to connect to Zapier
Just say so in plain English. Claude searches the connector directory and surfaces the Zapier MCP connector for you to approve.
- 2

Turn on connector search / approve the connection
A one-click consent step links your Zapier account to the conversation. This only needs to happen once.
- 3

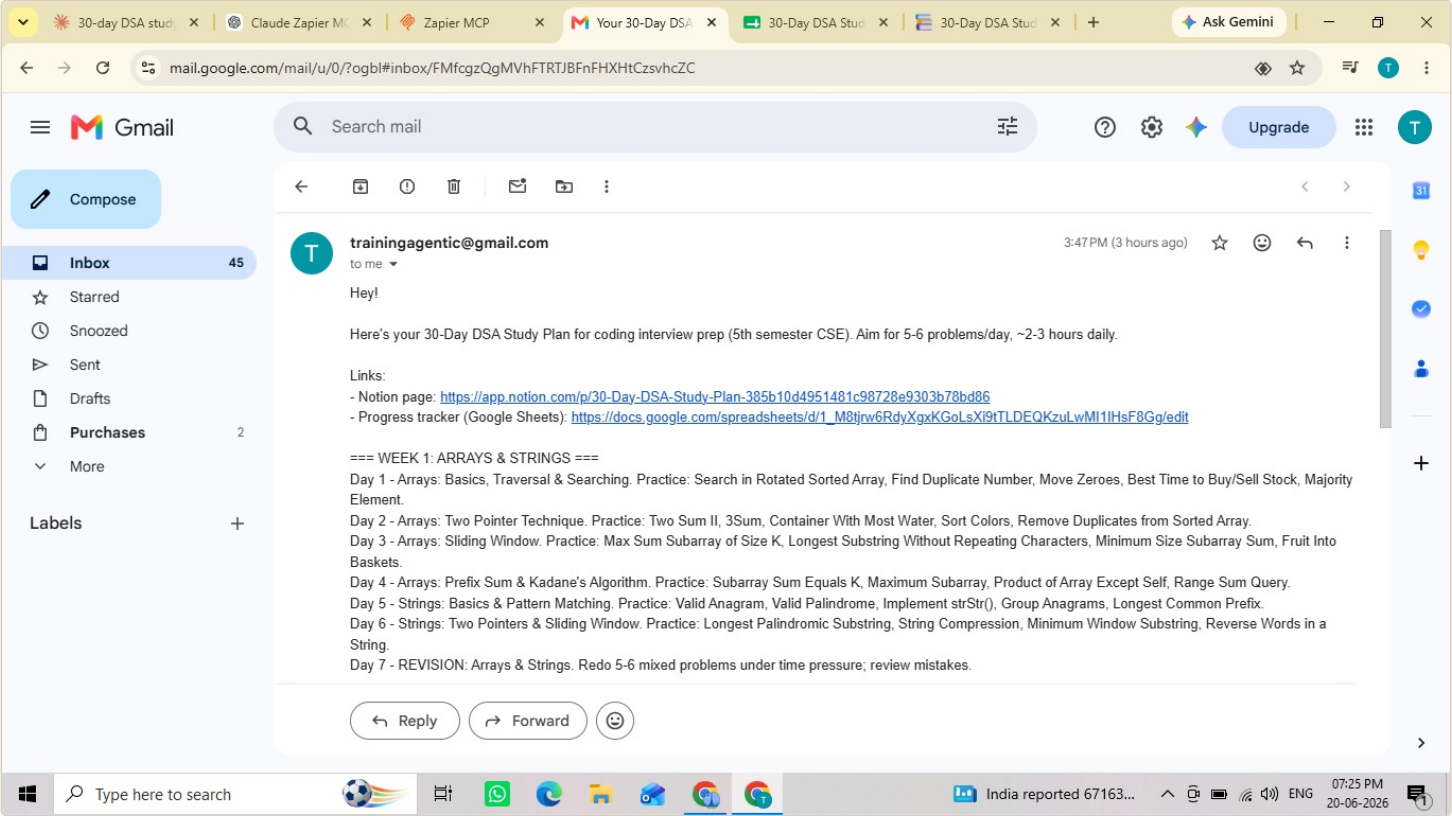
Enable the specific apps you want exposed
In the Zapier MCP dashboard, turn on the apps/actions Claude is allowed to use. For this demo, Notion, Google Sheets, and Gmail were already enabled — Claude detected that automatically.
- 4

Run the onboarding skill (optional, but a nice touch)
Claude listed the available Zapier Skills, found the built-in "onboarding" skill, and ran it to confirm the setup before doing anything else.
- 5

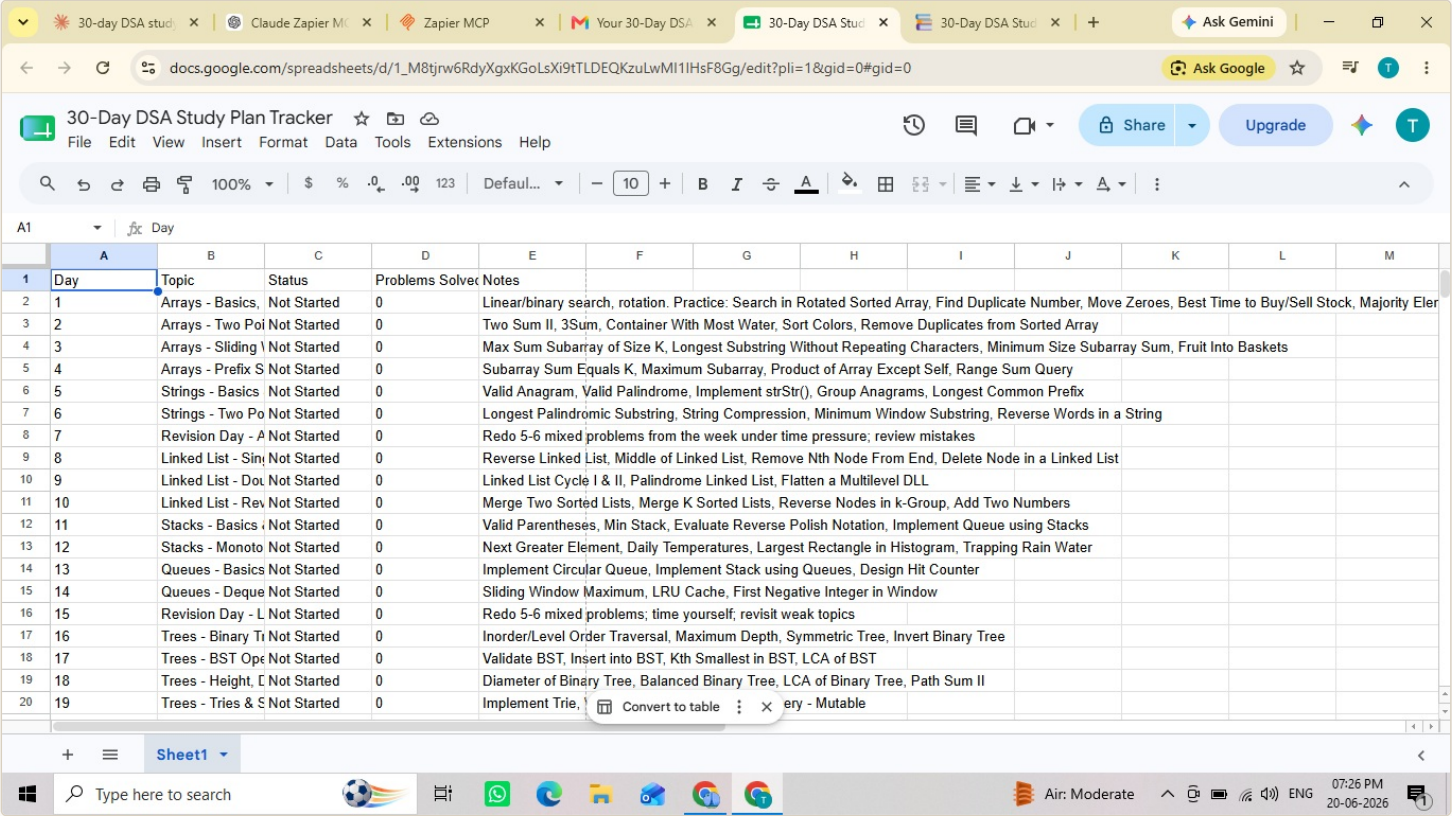
Describe the end goal, in one message
"Create a 30-day DSA plan, save it to Notion, build a tracker in Sheets, fill it in, and email me the plan." Claude breaks that down into the right sequence of tool calls on its own.
- 6

Claude executes — and every call is logged
Each individual action shows up in the Zapier MCP "Tool usage history" dashboard, fully timestamped and auditable. See the screenshots below.

The result, screenshotted



1 The email, in my actual inbox. Subject line, full 30-day plan, and links to the Notion page and the tracker — sent by Claude through Gmail via Zapier MCP, no drafting by hand.



2 The Google Sheets tracker, auto-filled. Day / Topic / Status / Problems Solved / Notes — all 30 rows created and populated by Claude, with Status defaulting to "Not Started" so I can update it as I go.

The image is a screenshot of a web browser displaying the Zapier MCP interface. The browser's address bar shows the URL 'mcp.zapier.com/mcp/servers/9d2eda1c-0797-41a6-a128-945d375f2af2/history'. The interface has a light gray sidebar on the left and a main content area on the right. In the sidebar, there's a 'Zapier MCP' header with a logo, a '+ New MCP Server' button, and a 'Claude MCP Server' section. Below this, there are statistics for 'Plan Tasks' (22 / 1k) and 'MCP Tasks' (22). At the bottom of the sidebar are links for 'Support & Help Center', 'Manage cookies', 'Manage embeds', and 'Training Agentic'. The main content area is titled 'Tool usage history' with the subtitle 'Recent tools used by your MCP server.' Below the title is a dropdown menu set to 'All actions' and a refresh button. A list of tool usage entries follows, each with an icon, the tool name, the timestamp, and a dropdown arrow. The entries are: 'Gmail: Send Email' (20/06/2026, 15:47:57), 'Google Sheets: API Request (Beta)' (20/06/2026, 15:47:23), 'Google Sheets: API Request (Beta)' (20/06/2026, 15:46:49), 'Google Sheets: Create Multiple Spreadsheet Rows' (20/06/2026, 15:46:25), 'Google Sheets: Create Spreadsheet' (20/06/2026, 15:45:21), 'Notion: Add Content to Page' (20/06/2026, 15:45:09), and 'Notion: Create Page'. The browser's taskbar at the bottom shows various application icons and the system clock indicating 07:26 PM on 20-06-2026.

What actually happened, step by step

Reconstructed from the Zapier MCP history panel — this is the real call sequence behind the three deliverables.

TOOL CALL	WHAT IT DID	NOTES
Notion: Create Page	Created the "30-Day DSA Study Plan" page under an existing Notion workspace page.	2 tasks
Notion: Add Content to Page	Wrote the full day-by-day markdown content (all 4 weeks) into the new page.	2 tasks
Google Sheets: Create Spreadsheet	Created "30-Day DSA Study Plan Tracker" with the 5 required column headers.	2 tasks
Google Sheets: Create Multiple Rows	Bulk-inserted 30 rows, one per study day.	2 tasks
Google Sheets: API Request (x3)	Verified the written data, and re-wrote two columns that needed a fix — direct API access for precision.	-6 tasks
Gmail: Send Email	Sent the full plan plus both links to my inbox with the requested subject line.	2 tasks

Free tier, by the numbers

Zapier MCP runs on your existing Zapier plan — there's no separate billing for it. Every **successful** tool call costs **2 tasks** from your plan's monthly task allowance (failed calls are free). That's the number to keep in your head when you're chaining several app actions together in one conversation.

22 / 1,000

PLAN TASKS USED THIS SESSION

2.2%

OF MONTHLY ALLOWANCE

My account's Zapier MCP dashboard showed a 1,000-task monthly allowance on the Free plan, with 22 used by the time this whole automation finished. Zapier's published free-tier numbers have changed more than once, so treat this as "what my dashboard showed today" rather than a permanent figure — always check [zapier.com/pricing](#) or your own dashboard for the current allowance before you plan around it.

This is just a demo

Everything above ran in a single chat, on a free account, as a one-off. That's the honest scope of this post. It's a great way to learn the pattern — it is not yet a production automation pipeline.

FREE TIER (what I used today)

- Good for trying ideas and personal, low-volume projects
- Task allowance resets monthly and is the hard ceiling
- Everything here was triggered manually, inside one conversation
- Great for learning how MCP + Claude actually work together

ON A PAID PLAN

- Higher task ceilings — room for real, repeated workflows
- Standing Zaps that trigger on events, not just on-demand chat calls
- Faster polling, team-shared app connections, priority support
- The same Claude + Zapier pattern becomes an always-on system

WHERE THIS GOES NEXT

With more headroom, this stops being "one conversation that built three things" and becomes a standing pipeline: a Zap that watches the tracker sheet for rows marked "Done" and sends a weekly progress recap automatically, or one that creates a calendar block for each study day, or nudges a Slack channel when a revision day is due. The more efficiently a plan's tasks are used, the more of this kind of routine work can run with almost no human intervention — Claude plans it once, and the automation just keeps going.

What I'm taking away from this

- ✓ **Describe the outcome once, not the steps.** I never said "open Notion, click New Page." I said what I wanted at the end, and Claude worked out the sequence of tool calls itself.
- ✓ **MCP turns chat into action.** The difference between "AI that talks" and "AI that does" is direct, authenticated tool access — that's exactly what Zapier MCP provides.
- ✓ **Dynamic discovery beats hard-coded IDs.** Claude asked Zapier what pages, sheets, and worksheets actually existed before filling in any field — no guessing, no broken links.
- ✓ **Every call is auditable.** The Zapier MCP history dashboard logs each action with a timestamp, so nothing happens silently or off the record.
- ✓ **Know the task math before you scale.** At 2 tasks per successful call, a 15-call workflow like this one costs roughly 30 tasks — fine on a free plan, but worth budgeting for if you're chaining many calls regularly.
- ✓ **Free tier is for learning; paid tier is for scaling.** This demo proved the pattern works. Turning it into a recurring, hands-off system is the natural next step.